



— PALM BEACH —
PICKLEBALL
— ACADEMY —

★ PRESENTS ★

BEGINNER PICKLEBALL HANDBOOK

— VOLUME 1 —

*Lessons Every
Beginner Should Know*





PALM BEACH
PICKLEBALL ACADEMY
LEARN • PLAY • IMPROVE

PALM BEACH **PICKLEBALL** **ACADEMY**

BEGINNER PICKLEBALL HANDBOOK

VOLUME 1

Learn • Play • Improve



Your Journey to Confidence, Skills & Fun!

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This handbook is intended for educational and instructional purposes only. It was created to help beginners learn the fundamentals of pickleball through simple explanations, practical tips, and easy-to-understand illustrations.

While every effort has been made to provide accurate information, readers should always follow the current USA Pickleball rules and exercise good judgment while practicing or playing. Participation in any sport involves inherent risks.

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WELCOME TO THE *Wonderful* WORLD OF PICKLEBALL!



Welcome!

I'm Charles Azoulay, and I'm delighted you've decided to learn one of the fastest-growing and most enjoyable sports in the world.

After many years of playing tennis and table tennis, I discovered pickleball—and it quickly became a passion. For more than ten years, I've enjoyed playing, volunteering, and helping introduce beginners to the game throughout Palm Beach County.

I created this handbook because I believe learning pickleball should be simple, enjoyable, and encouraging. Rather than overwhelming you with technical information, this book teaches one skill at a time through clear illustrations, practical tips, and lessons you can use immediately on the court.

Whether you're picking up a paddle for the very first time or returning after a break, my goal is to help you build confidence, improve your skills, and most importantly...

Have fun!

Welcome to the Palm Beach Pickleball Academy family.

Charles Azoulay

Founder & Instructor
Palm Beach Pickleball Academy



HOW TO USE THIS HANDBOOK

Get the most from this handbook by following these simple tips:



Learn one session at a time.



Practice each skill before moving on.



Don't worry about perfection.



Have fun and celebrate your progress.



Review sessions whenever you need a refresher.



Remember:

Every great pickleball player started as a beginner.
Enjoy the journey, keep practicing, and most of all... have fun!

TABLE OF CONTENTS



WELCOME

Welcome to the Wonderful World of Pickleball	xx
How to Use This Handbook	xx



GETTING STARTED

Session 1 – What Is Pickleball?	xx
Session 2 – Equipment & Choosing a Paddle	xx
Session 3 – Court Layout & Court Lines	xx
Session 4 – Safety & Pickleball Etiquette	xx
Session 5 – Ready Position	xx



FUNDAMENTAL STROKES

Session 6 – The Grip	xx
Session 7 – The Serve	xx
Session 8 – Returning the Serve	xx
Session 9 – Forehand	xx
Session 10 – Backhand	xx



BUILDING YOUR GAME

Session 11 – Volley	xx
Session 12 – Dink	xx
Session 13 – Third Shot Drop	xx
Session 14 – The Lob	xx
Session 15 – Overhead Smash	xx



COURT STRATEGY

Session 16 – Moving to the Kitchen	xx
Session 17 – Kitchen Control (NVZ)	xx
Session 18 – Court Positioning	xx
Session 19 – Playing Doubles	xx
Session 20 – Winning Strategies	xx



BEYOND THE BASICS

Session 21 – Shot Selection	xx
Session 22 – Reading Your Opponents	xx
Session 23 – Mental Game & Focus	xx
Session 24 – Practice & Drills	xx
Session 25 – Playing in Tournaments	xx



...and many more sessions!





What Is Pickleball?



WHAT IS PICKLEBALL?



Combines tennis, badminton and table tennis.



Easy to learn.



Fun for all ages and skill levels.



One of the fastest-growing sports in the world!



YOU'LL LEARN



Court basics



Paddle basics



Basic rules



How scoring works



Safe movement on the court



KEY TAKEAWAY

Pickleball is **easy** to learn, **fun** to play, and a sport you can **enjoy** for life.



SESSION 0

WARM-UP & STRETCHING

PREPARE YOUR BODY. PROTECT YOURSELF. PLAY YOUR BEST!



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A good warm-up increases blood flow, improves flexibility, prevents injuries, and gets you ready to have fun on the court!

WARM-UP FIRST!

5-10 MINUTES
BEFORE YOU PLAY



WARM-UP TIPS

- ✓ Move easily – don't rush.
- ✓ Breathe deeply.
- ✓ Stay hydrated.
- ✓ Listen to your body.
- ✓ Have fun!



DYNAMIC WARM-UP MOVES

1 NECK ROLLS



30 SEC

2 ARM CIRCLES



30 SEC

3 LEG SWINGS



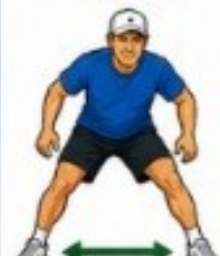
30 SEC
EACH LEG

4 LUNGES WITH TWIST



30 SEC
EACH SIDE

5 SIDE SHUFFLE



30 SEC
EACH WAY

6 HIGH KNEES



30 SEC

WHY WARM-UP?

- ♥ Increases heart rate and blood flow
- 🛡 Prevents strains and injuries
- 🏃 Improves agility, balance, and focus
- 😊 Helps you play better and have more fun!



DON'T FORGET TO STRETCH!

CALF STRETCH



20-30 SEC
EACH LEG

HAMSTRING STRETCH



20-30 SEC
EACH LEG

QUAD STRETCH



20-30 SEC
EACH LEG

SHOULDER STRETCH



20-30 SEC
EACH ARM

★ WARM UP WELL. PLAY STRONG. STAY SAFE. HAVE FUN! ★



Court Layout & Court Lines

Understanding the court helps you play with confidence!



WHAT TO KNOW



TEAM GAME

Pickleball is played as doubles (2 players per side).



THE NET

The net is 36 inches high at the sidelines and 34 inches in the center.



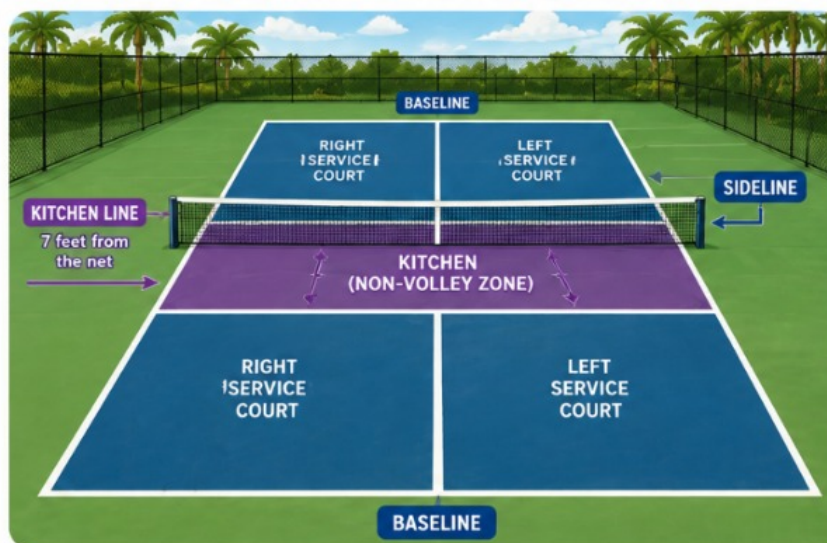
THE KITCHEN (NON-VOLLEY ZONE)

You cannot hit a volley while standing in the kitchen.



PLAY AREA

Stay in bounds and have fun!



COURT DIMENSIONS



Court Size

20 ft wide x 44 ft long



Net Height

36 in at sidelines
34 in at center



Kitchen (NVZ)

7 ft from the net
on both sides



Service Courts

Each side has right
and left service courts



Knowing your court
is the first step to
becoming a great player!



KEY TAKEAWAY

Learn your **court**, respect the **kitchen**,
and stay in control of every point!

Remember:

You win points by serving well,
moving smart, and working
together as a team!





Safety & Pickleball Etiquette

Good manners and safety make the game better for everyone!



COURT ETIQUETTE



SAFETY FIRST



EYES ON THE BALL

Always watch the ball to stay alert and avoid accidents.



BE AWARE

Be aware of your partners, opponents, and others around the court.



MOVE SAFELY

Avoid running through the kitchen (NVZ).
Use quick, short steps.



STAY HYDRATED

Take water breaks and listen to your body.



DRESS FOR SUCCESS

Wear appropriate clothing, shoes, and sun protection.



QUICK REMINDERS



No swearing or negative talk.



No slamming paddles or balls.



Wait for your turn to serve.



Don't distract others during play.



Have fun and make new friends!

BE RESPECTFUL



Be kind to your partners, opponents, and everyone on and off the court.

CALL THE SCORE



The server calls the score clearly before every serve.

LINE CALLS



Make your line calls honestly. If unsure, call it in.

KEEP IT POSITIVE



Encourage your partner and enjoy the game.
Good attitude = better play!

KEEP COURTS CLEAN



Leave the court better than you found it.
Pick up trash and respect the facility.



*Good players follow the rules.
Great players respect the game!*

KEY TAKEAWAY



Safety and respect keep the game fun for everyone. Good manners on the court show you're a true pickleball player!



*Play smart,
be kind, and
enjoy every
moment!*

The Serve – Start Every Point Strong



SERVE BASICS



UNDERHAND ONLY

The paddle must hit the ball below your waist.



BEHIND THE BASELINE

Both feet must be behind the baseline when you serve.



DIAGONAL SERVE

Serve crosscourt to the opponent's service court.



ONE BOUNCE RULE

The ball must bounce once on each side before volleys.



CALL THE SCORE

Always call the score before every serve.

A good serve puts you in control from the very first shot!



SERVE CHECKLIST



Eyes on the target



Paddle back and ready



Smooth underhand swing



Hit the ball below your waist



Aim deep to the back of the court



Stay calm and be consistent



SERVE STRATEGIES



SERVE DEEP

Hit deep serves to push your opponents back and give yourself more time.



SERVE WIDE

Aim to the backhand side or wide to make returns more difficult.



MIX IT UP

Change your speed, placement, and spin to keep opponents guessing.



STAY CONSISTENT

A good, safe serve is better than risk and missing.



The serve is your opportunity to start every point on your terms!

A consistent serve is one of the easiest ways to score!



KEY TAKEAWAY

A smart, consistent serve gives you the advantage and helps you win more points!

Coach's Tip:

Practice your serve 10–15 minutes every day. Consistency creates confidence!



The Serve – Start Every Point Strong



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The Backhand

Consistency, control, and reliability!

BACKHAND TECHNIQUE – STEP BY STEP

★ WHY IT MATTERS

A solid backhand helps you handle more shots, stay in the rally longer, and make fewer unforced errors. It's a key to becoming a well-rounded player.

🎯 KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Better court coverage
- ✓ More control and accuracy
- ✓ Stronger defense
- ✓ More shot options
- ✓ More consistency
- ✓ More confidence!



A reliable backhand makes you a tough opponent!



1 READY POSITION

Get in your ready position. Hold the paddle in front with a relaxed grip.



2 TURN SIDWAYS

Turn your shoulders sideways. Paddle back with your elbow up.



3 STEP & PREPARE

Step forward with your opposite foot. Keep your eye on the ball.



4 CONTACT IN FRONT

Hit the ball in front of your body. Use a compact swing and keep your wrist firm.



5 FOLLOW THROUGH

Finish across your body and return to your ready position.



WHERE TO AIM

CROSSCOURT
To the backhand corner

MIDDLE
Between the players

DOWN THE LINE
Deep to the baseline

SMART TARGETS

- 🎯 **Deep crosscourt**
Push your opponents wide and out of position.
- 🎯 **Middle of the court**
The safest and most consistent target.
- 🎯 **Down the line**
Use to surprise and create space.



KEY COACHING TIPS



USE A TWO-HANDED GRIP
It gives you more control and stability.



WATCH THE BALL
Keep your eyes on the ball all the way to contact.



KEEP IT COMPACT
A short swing gives you better control and faster recovery.



HIT OUT IN FRONT
Contact the ball in front of your body for more consistency.



MOVE YOUR FEET
Good footwork helps you get in position and stay balanced.



Practice makes consistency – consistency wins matches!



Great backhands don't come from strength – they come from good technique!



KEY TAKEAWAY

A consistent backhand gives you control, keeps you in the rally, and opens up more opportunities to win the point!

Coach's Tip:

*Drill, drill, drill!
Repetition builds muscle memory and confidence.*



The Volley

Control the game up at the net!

VOLLEY TECHNIQUE – STEP BY STEP

★ WHY IT MATTERS

Volleys are hit before the ball bounces. They help you control the pace, put away weak shots, and win points faster at the net.

🎯 KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Take the ball early
- ✓ More control
- ✓ Less power needed
- ✓ Put pressure on opponents
- ✓ Win more points at the net

 Great volleys are about control, not power! Be soft, be ready, and be confident!



1 READY POSITION

Get to the net and get in your ready position. Paddle up, eyes on the ball.



2 UNIT TURN

Turn your shoulders slightly and keep your paddle in front of your body.



3 CONTACT IN FRONT

Meet the ball in front of your body, at about chest height. Keep your paddle face firm.



4 SHORT, CONTROLLED MOTION

Use a short, compact punch. Let the ball do the work.



5 RECOVER

Return to your ready position and be prepared for the next shot.



COMMON VOLLEY TARGETS

CROSSCOURT VOLLEY

To the opposite side corner

MIDDLE VOLLEY

To the middle – splits the opponents

DOWN THE LINE VOLLEY

To the open sideline

WHAT TO AVOID

- ✗ Hitting too hard – leads to errors.
- ✗ Dropping your paddle – keep it up and in front.
- ✗ Reaching – move your feet instead.
- ✗ Looking away – always watch the ball.



KEY COACHING TIPS



PADDLE UP

Keep your paddle up and in front of your body.



WATCH THE BALL

Keep your eyes on the ball all the way to your paddle.



SOFT HANDS

Use a relaxed grip and soft hands to keep the ball low and controlled.



PUNCH, DON'T SWING

Use a short punch instead of a big swing.



STAY BALANCED

Stay on the balls of your feet and be ready to move in any direction.



Volleys win at the net – soft, quick, and in control!

★ KEY TAKEAWAY

Volleys are about **control** and **placement**, not power. Stay relaxed, be **ready**, and let the ball come to you!

Coach's Tip:

Drill, drill, drill! Repetition builds muscle memory and confidence.

The best volleys are short, soft, and smart!



The Dink

Patience, touch, and strategy!

Dinking is a soft shot hit into the Non-Volley Zone (kitchen). It's the key to building the rally, creating openings, and winning points.

HOW TO DINK - STEP BY STEP



1 READY POSITION

Get low with paddle in front and eyes on the ball.



2 SOFT GRIP

Use a relaxed grip to keep the paddle loose and absorb the ball.



3 GENTLE CONTACT

Use a soft touch. Let the ball drop and tap it lightly over the net.



4 KEEP IT LOW

Aim to land the ball in the kitchen, just over the net.



5 RECOVER

Return to your ready position and get prepared for the next shot.

WHERE TO DINK



Dink crosscourt. Aim for the middle or each corner of the kitchen. Keep the ball low and consistent.

DINKING TIPS

- ✓ Dink crosscourt most of the time.
- ✓ Keep the ball low and soft.
- ✓ Aim for the middle or corners of the kitchen.
- ✓ Be patient and wait for the right ball to attack.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Dinking is about patience, control, and consistency. Keep it low, keep it soft, and let the right opportunity come to you!



WHY IT MATTERS

Dinking slows the game down, keeps the ball low, and makes your opponents hit up. It sets you up to attack when the right opportunity comes.



KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Greater control of the point
- ✓ Forces opponents to make mistakes
- ✓ Creates opportunities to attack
- ✓ Improves consistency and patience
- ✓ Win more points!



Great dinking leads to great results!

Be patient, keep it low, and let your opponent make the mistake!



KEY COACHING TIPS



WATCH THE BALL

Track the ball all the way from your opponent's paddle to yours.



USE A RELAXED GRIP

A loose grip helps you control the soft touch.



KEEP IT LOW

The lower the dink, the harder it is for your opponent to attack.



MOVE YOUR FEET

Small steps keep you balanced and ready to react.



THINK AHEAD

Good dinking leads to openings. Be ready to move forward and attack!



Master the dink and you'll control the game!

Coach's Tip:

Practice dinking every day for 10-15 minutes. Patience wins points!





The Third Shot Drop

Turn defense into offense!

The third shot drop is the key to moving from the baseline to the kitchen (Non-Volley Zone) and taking control of the point.

THIRD SHOT DROP – STEP BY STEP



1 READ & PREPARE
Watch the return of serve. Get in ready position.



2 MOVE & SET UP
Step into the shot with your paddle back and low.



3 SOFT CONTACT
Use a soft touch. Open the paddle face slightly.



4 DROP IT SHORT
Aim to land the ball in the kitchen, just over the net.



5 MOVE UP
Move forward confidently to the kitchen.

WHERE TO AIM



CROSSCOURT
To the opposite kitchen corner

MIDDLE
In the middle of the kitchen

DOWN THE LINE
To the open kitchen corner

KEYS TO A GREAT THIRD SHOT DROP



Paddle face open



Soft hands, not a swing



Hit down on the ball



Land it short in the kitchen



Move up after the drop



KEY COACHING TIPS



WATCH THE RETURN

Read your opponent and be ready early.



USE A SOFT TOUCH

This is not a drive. It's a finesse shot.



KEEP IT LOW

The ball should travel just over the net.



AIM SHORT

Land in the kitchen, not deep.



MOVE UP

After the drop, move up to the kitchen with confidence.



The third shot drop is your best friend – use it wisely!



WHY IT MATTERS

A good third shot drop neutralizes the opponents' advantage at the net, gives you time to move up, and sets you up for dinks, volleys, and winning points.



KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Neutralizes strong serves and aggressive players
- ✓ Gets you to the kitchen safely
- ✓ Creates time and space
- ✓ Sets up dinks and attacks
- ✓ Leads to more winning points!



A good drop shot isn't just a soft shot... it's a smart shot!

Soft, deep, and short – that's the magic!

KEY TAKEAWAY

A soft, deep, and short drop shot gets you to the kitchen and turns defense into offense!

Coach's Tip:

Practice your drops every day. Consistency builds confidence and wins points!





Game Play: Basic Rules

Simple rules. Big fun. Let's play!

Pickleball is easy to learn but has some important rules.
Knowing them helps everyone have a better game and more fun.

BASIC RULES YOU MUST KNOW

1

SERVE UNDERHAND

Serve underhand diagonally and land the ball in the opposite court.



2

LET THE BALL BOUNCE

After the serve, each side must let the ball bounce once before volleying.



3

THE NON-VOLLEY ZONE (KITCHEN)

You cannot hit a volley while standing in the kitchen. You must let the ball bounce.



4

RALLY CONTINUES

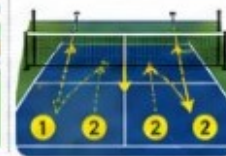
Keep hitting back and forth until someone makes a mistake.



5

DOUBLE BOUNCE RULE

The first two hits (serve and return) must bounce once on each side.



WHY IT MATTERS

Following the rules keeps the game fair, fun, and safe. It shows respect for other players and helps everyone enjoy pickleball more.



KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Better understanding of the game
- ✓ Fewer arguments
- ✓ Smoother, faster games
- ✓ More confidence
- ✓ More fun for everyone!



Good sports follow the rules. Great players play with respect!



KEY COACHING TIPS



PLAY WITH PURPOSE

Understand the rules and play with a plan.



RESPECT THE GAME

Follow the rules and respect your opponents.



ASK IF UNSURE

If you're not sure about a call, ask politely.



PRACTICE MAKES BETTER

The more you play, the more natural the rules become.



Great games start with good players who respect the rules!

HOW A GAME WORKS



SCORING

You only score when your team is serving. (Rally Scoring)



SERVE SEQUENCE

Both serve at the start of the game. Then only the serving team continues to serve.



WINNING

Games are usually played to 11 points, win by 2.

BE A GREAT PLAYER



Know the rules



Communicate with your partner



Be positive and encouraging



Have fun!



KEY TAKEAWAY

Know the rules, play with respect, and have fun! Pickleball is a game for life – let's keep it positive and enjoyable for all!

Coach's Tip:

When in doubt, be kind, be fair, and keep the game moving!



Know the rules, play the game, and enjoy the experience!



Scoring, Serving Team & Side Out

How points are scored and games are won!

Understanding scoring helps you keep track of the game and play with confidence.



WHY IT MATTERS

Knowing how to score and who serves keeps the game organized and fair. It helps you focus on playing your best!



KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ No more confusion
- ✓ Play with confidence
- ✓ Keep the game moving
- ✓ Understand your role
- ✓ Have more fun!



Great players know the score, stay focused, and enjoy the game!

Know the rules, play smart, and always have fun!

SCORING THE GAME OF PICKLEBALL

1

ONLY THE SERVING TEAM CAN SCORE

You score a point when the opposing team hits the ball out or into the net.



2

RALLY SCORING

Every rally counts. Points are scored no matter who served.



Example Score

3

GAMES ARE PLAYED TO 11

You must win by 2 points. (11-9, 12-10, etc.)



4

CHANGE SIDES

Teams change sides when the serving team scores an odd number of points.



KEY COACHING TIPS



WATCH THE SCORE

Keep track of the score in your head.



COMMUNICATE

Talk with your partner about who is serving and the score.



STAY FOCUSED

Every point matters. Don't relax!



CHANGE SIDES ON TIME

Change sides when the serving team scores an odd number.



KNOW YOUR ROLE

Know when you serve and where you start.



Good teams keep score, communicate, and play with confidence!

SERVING TEAM & SIDE OUT – HOW IT WORKS

SERVING TEAM

- Team that wins the serve will serve first.
- The server starts on the right side of the court.
- Serve underhand diagonally to the opposite court.



RIGHT SERVER STARTS HERE

LEFT SERVER NEXT

SERVER SWITCHES SIDES AFTER EACH POINT

SIDE OUT

- If the receiving team wins the rally, they become the new serving team.
- The first server on that team serves from the right side.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Score when your opponents make a mistake, play to 11, win by 2, and always change sides on an odd number. Keep learning and have fun!

Coach's Tip:

Keep the score in your head, encourage your partner, and celebrate every point!





RETURN OF SERVE

Take Control from the First Shot!

A smart return sets you up to win!

YOUR GOALS

- ✓ Keep opponents back
- ✓ Gain time to move in
- ✓ Be ready for the next shot



*Return Deep...
Then Move Forward!*

RETURN DEEP!

1 RETURN DEEP



- ✓ Aim near the opponent's baseline.
- ✓ Keep them back.
- ✓ Give yourself time to move forward.

2 MOVE TO THE KITCHEN



- ✓ Return the ball.
- ✓ Move immediately forward.
- ✓ Get to the NVZ (kitchen) line.

3 READY FOR THE NEXT SHOT



- ✓ Paddle up.
- ✓ Knees bent.
- ✓ Eyes on the ball.
- ✓ Split-step before your opponent hits.

4 COMMON MISTAKES



★ PRO TIP

A deep return gives you extra time to reach the kitchen and puts your opponents on defense.



★ KEY TAKEAWAY

*Hit deep. Move quickly.
Own the kitchen!*





FOREHAND GROUNDSTROKES

Your Power Shot!

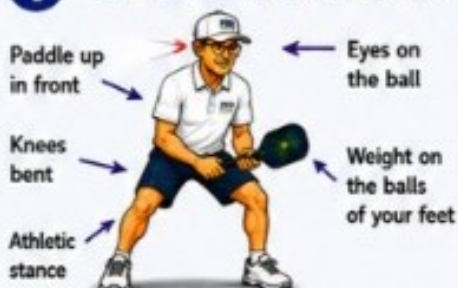
Use a smooth swing and let the paddle do the work!



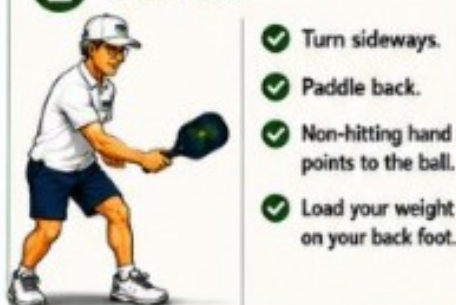
KEY POINTS

- ✓ Turn your body sideways.
- ✓ Step into the shot.
- ✓ Swing low to high.
- ✓ Follow through toward your target.
- ✓ Keep your eyes on the ball.

1 THE READY POSITION



2 PREPARE



3 SWING



4 FOLLOW THROUGH



WHERE TO HIT



COMMON MISTAKES



★ PRO TIP

A relaxed swing creates more power and better control!

★ KEY TAKEAWAY

*Smooth swing. Step in. Follow through.
That's the winning Formula!*





BACKHAND GROUNDSTROKES

Control, Consistency, Confidence!

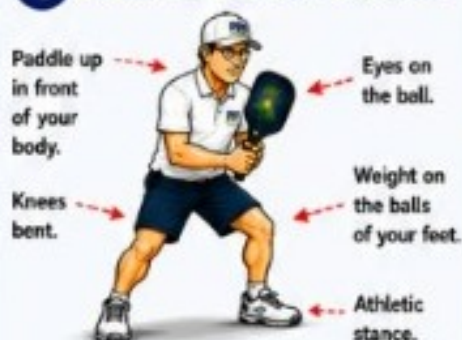
A great backhand gives you control from anywhere on the court!

KEY POINTS

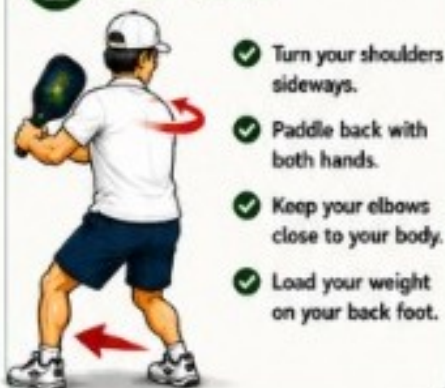
- ✓ Use two hands for better control.
- ✓ Turn your shoulders sideways.
- ✓ Step into the shot.
- ✓ Swing from low to high.
- ✓ Keep your paddle in front.
- ✓ Follow through toward your target.
- ✓ Keep your eyes on the ball.

*Two Hands. Solid Contact.
Great Results!*

1 BACKHAND READY POSITION



2 UNIT TURN



- ✓ Turn your shoulders sideways.
- ✓ Paddle back with both hands.
- ✓ Keep your elbows close to your body.
- ✓ Load your weight on your back foot.

3 STEP INTO THE SHOT



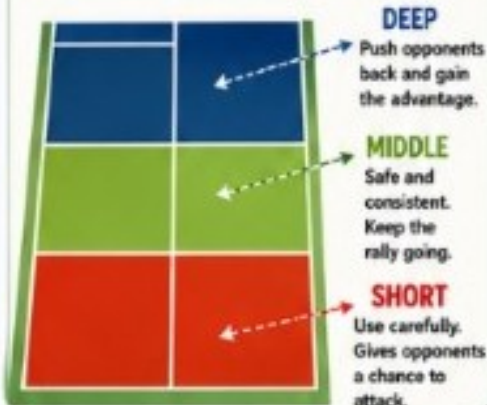
- ✓ Step forward with your front foot.
- ✓ Transfer your weight forward.
- ✓ Get your body behind the ball.
- ✓ Stay balanced and ready.

4 SWING & FOLLOW THROUGH



- ✓ Swing from low to high.
- ✓ Keep your paddle in front of you.
- ✓ Make solid contact out in front.
- ✓ Finish high toward your target.
- ✓ Keep your eyes on the ball.

WHERE TO HIT



- DEEP**
Push opponents back and gain the advantage.
- MIDDLE**
Safe and consistent. Keep the rally going.
- SHORT**
Use carefully. Gives opponents a chance to attack.

COMMON MISTAKES



★ PRO TIP

A compact backhand with good footwork keeps you in control and sets you up for success!

★ KEY TAKEAWAY

*Two hands. Turn. Step. Swing.
Control the ball and the game!*



At the kitchen line, the volley is your best friend!

VOLLEY

Quick Hands, Great Control!



Punch it, Don't Swing it!

KEY POINTS

- ✓ Meet the ball out in front.
- ✓ Use a short, compact swing.
- ✓ Keep your paddle face slightly open.
- ✓ Stay balanced and ready.
- ✓ Keep your eyes on the ball.

1 READY POSITION



Be alert and ready.

2 MEET THE BALL OUT FRONT



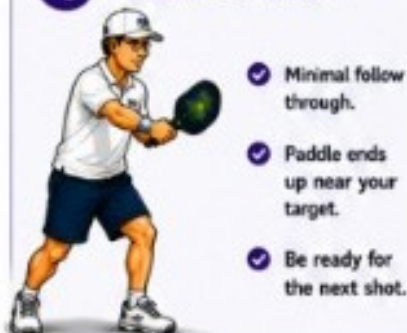
Out in front = more control.

3 PUNCH, DON'T SWING



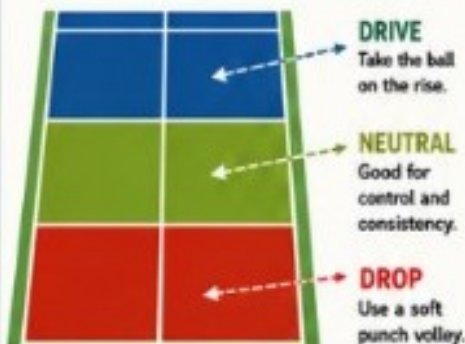
A punch volley keeps the ball low and gives you control.

4 FOLLOW THROUGH



Short and simple.

WHERE TO VOLLEY FROM



Know your options.

COMMON MISTAKES



★ PRO TIP

Think "punch and stay ready." Your volley is a weapon at the kitchen!

★ KEY TAKEAWAY

*Quick hands. Soft touch.
Great control. **Big results!***

SESSION 43

ATTACK FROM TRANSITION!

TURN DEFENSE INTO OFFENSE.
MOVE UP. TAKE CONTROL.



After the return, don't stay back. Transition forward, take the middle, and attack with purpose!

TRANSITION FORWARD.
OWN THE MIDDLE.
FINISH THE POINT!

QUICK TIP



Good transitions start with split step, low paddle, and always thinking "middle first!"

THE BALL MAY COME TO THE SIDES, BUT THE POINT IS WON IN THE MIDDLE!

HOW TO ATTACK FROM TRANSITION

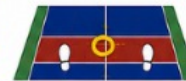
- 1 Return the ball deep and cross-court when possible.



- 2 Move forward together after the return.



- 3 Take the middle of the court.



- 4 Look for a short ball to attack.



- 5 Stay aggressive and control the middle of the court!

★ MIDDLE CONTROL WINS POINTS!

KEYS TO A GOOD TRANSITION



Split step on your return.



Return deep and with good height.



Move up together as a team.



Take the middle early.



Control the center, win the point.



Staying back after the return.



Moving up too slow or out of sync.



Hitting the ball too soft.



Attacking from the sidelines.



Leaving the middle open.

★ TRANSITION. TAKE THE MIDDLE. ATTACK WITH PURPOSE. WIN THE POINT! ★



Winning Doubles Communication!

Talk. Trust. Win Together!

“The strongest shots come from your paddle.
The strongest team comes from your communication.”

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

- ✓ Why communication is the secret weapon in doubles.
- ✓ The key words and calls every team should use.
- ✓ How to avoid confusion and partner collision.
- ✓ How to encourage and support your partner.
- ✓ How good communication leads to more wins and more fun.
- ✓ Drills to improve your teamwork and timing.

I've got the middle!

You take that one!

KEY TAKEAWAY

Great teams talk, trust, and work together.
Good communication eliminates confusion and creates winning opportunities!

1. WHY COMMUNICATION MATTERS

Pickleball is faster in doubles. Good communication keeps you both on the same page.

- ✓ Avoids confusion and collisions.
- ✓ Covers the court as a team.
- ✓ Builds trust and confidence.
- ✓ Creates more winning shots.



★ **TIP:** Talk early, talk often, and keep it positive!

2. KEY WORDS & CALLS TO USE

MINE!

Mine!
Call the ball early so your partner knows to let it go.

YOURS!

Yours!
Let your partner take it.

MIDDLE!

Middle!
You take the middle, I'll cover the line.

SWITCH!

Switch!
Change sides or positions.

I'M BACK!

I'm Back!
Let your partner know you're ready.

TALK BEFORE THE POINT

- ✓ Discuss your strategy.
- ✓ Confirm who covers middle.
- ✓ Agree on starting positions.
- ✓ Encourage each other!

★ **TIP:** A quick call can prevent a big mistake!

3. AVOID CONFUSION & COLLISIONS

Two players going for the same ball = missed shot or accident!



- ✓ Call the ball early.
- ✓ Respect your partner's call.
- ✓ Cover your zones.
- ✓ Trust the plan.

★ **TIP:** Clear communication keeps you safe and keeps the ball in play!

4. ENCOURAGE & SUPPORT

Pickleball is more fun when your partner feels supported!

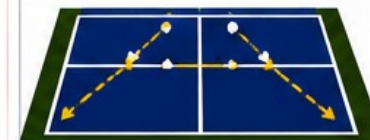
- ✓ "Great shot!"
- ✓ "Nice try!"
- ✓ "Way to go!"
- ✓ "Good call!"
- ✓ "Let's keep it up!"



★ **TIP:** Positive teams play better and stay together!

5. COVER THE COURT TOGETHER

Work as one unit. Balance is the key!



- ✓ Stay balanced – not side by side.
- ✓ Adjust based on the ball.
- ✓ Close the gaps.
- ✓ Always have a plan.

★ **TIP:** Move together and cover together!

PRACTICE DRILL

Communication Challenge (With a Partner)

- 1 Play points and use key words.
- 2 Call every ball.
- 3 Encourage your partner after every point.
- 4 Switch roles and repeat.

Goal: Communicate on every point for 10 minutes without confusion!



COACH CHARLES' CONFIDENCE METER

Color in one star each time you successfully complete the Communication Challenge!



We're talking!

We're getting better!

We're on the same page!

Great teamwork today!

Championship communication!

REMEMBER

- ✓ Talk early.
- ✓ Call the ball.
- ✓ Encourage your partner.
- ✓ Trust your partner.
- ✓ Work together.

Good communication, better pickleball!



Great job! See you in Lesson 43 –
Read Your Opponent, Stay One Step Ahead!



Talk. Trust.
Win together!

The LOB SHOT



Lift it high.
Reset the point.



Use the lob
when opponents
are close to the
kitchen.



HOW TO USE THE LOB

- 1 Notice opponents crowding the kitchen.



- 2 Hit the ball high and deep.



- 3 Move back and reset your position.



- 4 Be ready for the next shot.



KEY POINTS



Hit high enough
to go over
their heads.



Aim deep to
give yourself
more time.



Use the lob to
improve your court
position.



Don't overuse it—
surprise makes
it effective!



Control the Kitchen, Control the Point!

Own the **Non-Volley Zone (NVZ)**
and You'll Own the Game!

“ The kitchen is
where points are won
or lost—take control! ”

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

- ✓ What the Non-Volley Zone (NVZ) is and why it matters.
- ✓ How to approach and attack the kitchen.
- ✓ How to reset when you're pushed back.
- ✓ How to keep your opponents out of the NVZ.
- ✓ Common kitchen mistakes and how to fix them.
- ✓ Drills to dominate the kitchen with confidence.

Get to the
kitchen early
and stay
in control!

Keep them
back, take
control, and
finish strong!

THE KITCHEN
(NON-VOLLEY ZONE)

KEY TAKEAWAY

Control the kitchen, control the pace,
control the point! Own the NVZ and
make your opponents uncomfortable.

1. WHAT IS THE KITCHEN (NVZ)?

The Non-Volley Zone (NVZ) is the 7-foot area
on both sides of the net where you cannot
volley the ball.



★ **TIP:** You can be in the kitchen
but you can't volley the ball while in it.

2. KEYS TO KITCHEN SUCCESS

- Get Low and Ready**
Bend your knees and stay balanced.
- Take Small Steps**
Move in with control, not speed.
- Keep the Paddle Up**
Stay ready for soft shots.
- Stay Patient**
Wait for the right ball to attack.
- Communicate**
Work together and cover smart.

★ **TIP:** Patience in the kitchen leads to
opportunities and easy points!

3. HOW TO ATTACK THE KITCHEN

- ✓ Approach with a soft, low shot (dink).
- ✓ Move up behind your shot.
- ✓ Stay low and be ready.
- ✓ Look for a ball to attack (a pop-up
or a short ball).
- ✓ Hit down and forward.



★ **TIP:** Soft hands to enter.
Smart shot to finish!

4. HOW TO KEEP THEM OUT

- ✗ Dink deep, down the middle.
- ✗ Change direction side to side.
- ✗ Hit to their backhand.
- ✗ Use angles.
- ✗ Be consistent and patient.
- ✗ Don't try to hit a winner
every shot!



★ **TIP:** Consistency beats power
when keeping them back!

5. IF YOU GET PUSHED BACK

- ✓ Reset with a high, deep shot.
- ✓ Take your time and move up again.
- ✓ Don't force it.
- ✓ Wait for a better ball.
- ✓ Get back to the kitchen
as soon as you can.

★ **TIP:** Reset smart, then
move up and take control
again!

PRACTICE DRILL

Kitchen Control Drill (With a Partner)

- 1 Start at the baseline.
- 2 Rally with dinks.
- 3 One player tries to move up.
- 4 The other tries to keep them back.
- 5 Switch roles.

Goal: Win the point by controlling
the kitchen and creating an opening!



COACH CHARLES' CONFIDENCE METER

Color in one star each time you successfully
complete the Kitchen Control Drill.



I'm just starting. I'm getting better! I can stay in the kitchen longer. I create openings consistently! I own the kitchen!

REMEMBER

- ✓ Control the kitchen.
- ✓ Keep your opponents back.
- ✓ Be patient and consistent.
- ✓ Attack the right ball.
- ✓ Work together as a team.

Own the kitchen,
own the game!



Great job! See you in Lesson 40 –
Attack Smart, Not Hard!



Stay calm,
stay smart,
stay in control!

THE THIRD SHOT DROP

The key to getting to the kitchen and taking control!



A soft shot that lands in the kitchen and makes it hard for opponents to attack.



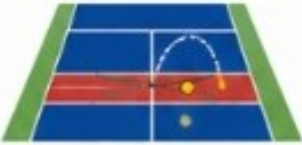
**KITCHEN
(NON-VOLLEY ZONE)**

HOW TO HIT THE THIRD SHOT DROP

- 1 Approach the ball after the return.

- 2 Use a soft grip and open paddle face.

- 3 Gently brush up on the back of the ball.

- 4 Aim to land the ball short in the kitchen.


WHY IT WORKS



Neutralizes aggressive returns.



Gets you and your partner to the kitchen.



Creates a weak response from your opponents.



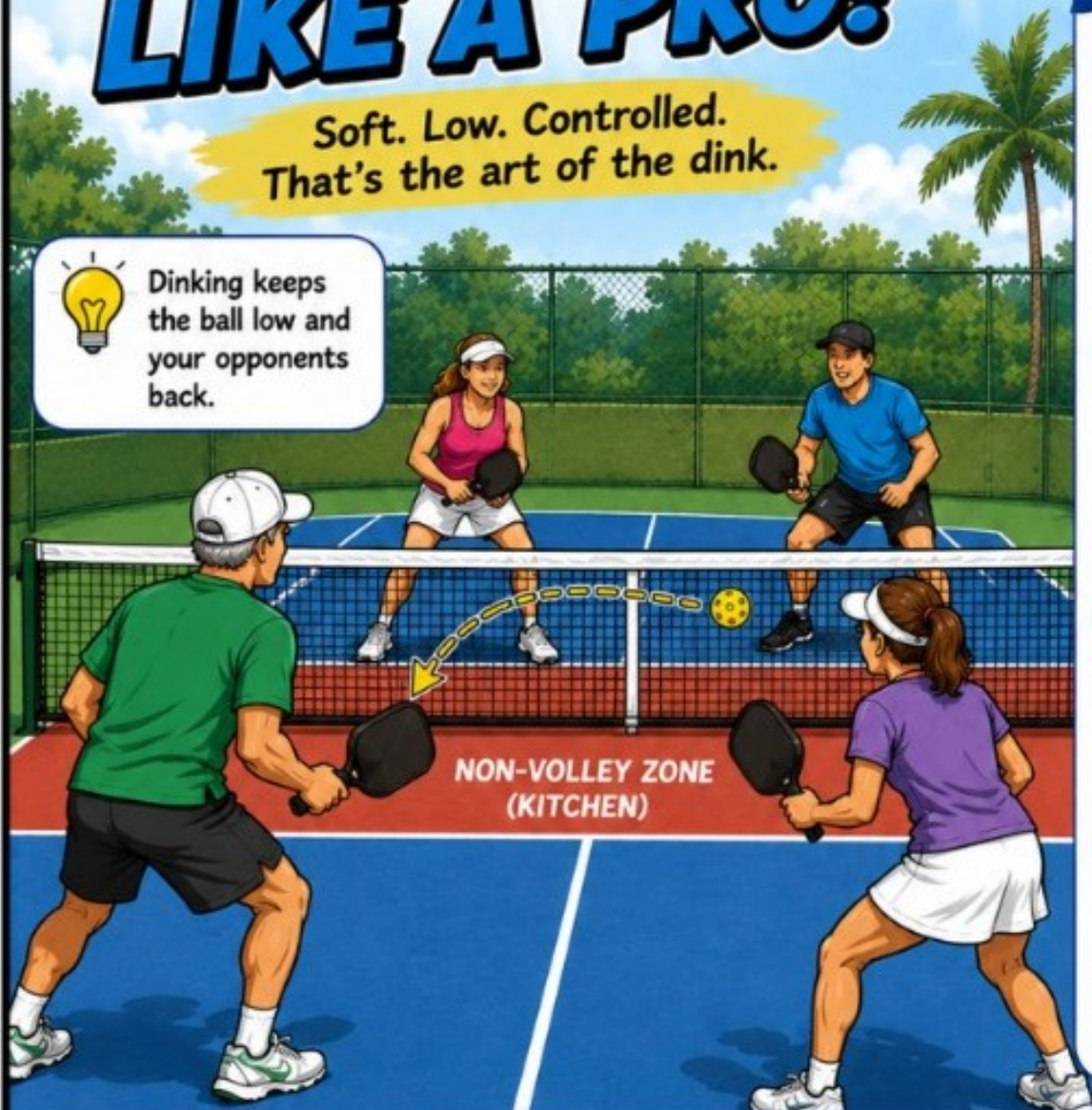
Puts you in control of the point!

WHEN & HOW TO DINK LIKE A PRO!

Soft. Low. Controlled.
That's the art of the dink.



Dinking keeps
the ball low and
your opponents
back.

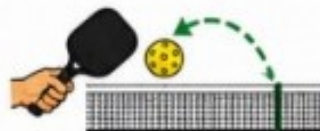


HOW TO DINK EFFECTIVELY

- 1 Use a soft grip
and open paddle
face.



- 2 Hit the ball softly
just over the net.



- 3 Keep the ball in
the kitchen.



- 4 Stay patient and
wait for the right
opportunity!



BEST TIMES TO DINK



When opponents
are at the baseline.



After your serve
(3rd shot) to gain
the advantage.



When the ball
is below net
height.



When you want to
control the pace
of the game.

DOUBLES POSITIONING

WORK TOGETHER. COVER SMARTER. WIN MORE.



Good positioning helps you cover more court and win more points.

Middle
(Dominant Side)

Outside
(Backhand Side)

QUICK TIP



Stay in your lane and communicate!

KEY TAKEAWAYS



Middle player covers most cross-court shots.



Outside player protects the line and backhand.



Talk, move and anticipate together.



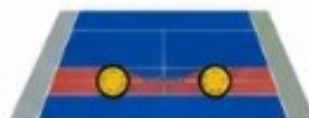
Great positioning turns defense into offense!



**PALM BEACH
PICKLEBALL
ACADEMY**

HOW TO POSITION LIKE A TEAM

- 1 Start in a balanced ready position.



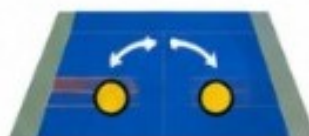
- 2 The ball goes cross court. Partner in the middle covers.



- 3 You take your side and cover the line.



- 4 Communicate and move together.



THE FOURTH SHOT

**THE SETUP SHOT THAT
CREATES OPPORTUNITY!**



The fourth shot turns defense into offense. Make it count!

AFTER THE THIRD SHOT DROP

**NVZ
(Non-Volley Zone)**

**AIM DEEP
OR TO THE
WEAKER SIDE**

QUICK TIP



Don't rush!
Be patient, stay low, and hit with purpose.

KEY PURPOSES



Move from defense to offense.



Put pressure on your opponents.



Create an opening to attack.



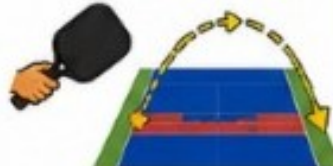
Win more points!

HOW TO EXECUTE THE FOURTH SHOT

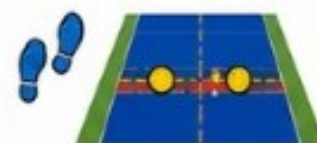
- 1 After the third shot drop, move up to the kitchen line.



- 2 Hit a controlled shot deep or to the weaker side.



- 3 Get to the kitchen line and be ready.



- 4 Prepare for the next shot and take control of the rally!



★ GOOD FOURTH SHOT = MORE OPPORTUNITIES = MORE WINS! ★



DRIVE SHOT

THE POWER SHOT THAT KEEPS
THE BALL LOW AND FAST!



A drive shot is a firm, flat shot hit with pace. It keeps your opponents on the defensive.

HIT THROUGH
THE BALL!

KITCHEN
(NON-VOLLEY ZONE)

QUICK TIP



Keep your paddle face slightly closed and follow through toward your target.

HOW TO HIT A DRIVE SHOT

- 1 Get in an athletic ready position.



- 2 Take the ball early and out in front.



- 3 Swing forward with compact power.



- 4 Aim low and drive the ball deep.



★ Keep it low, fast and under control!

WHEN TO USE THE DRIVE SHOT



When opponents are back in the court.



To neutralize a high ball.



To speed up the game.



To create offensive opportunities.



Keeps opponents on the defensive.



Creates pace and pressure.



Leads to more winning shots!

★ DRIVE WITH PURPOSE. CONTROL THE PACE. WIN THE POINT! ★



RESET SHOT

THE SMART SHOT THAT BRINGS
YOU BACK INTO THE RALLY!



A reset shot is a soft, high shot that gives you time, space and gets you back in control.

HIGH, SOFT, SAFE.

Give yourself time and get back in position.

QUICK TIP



When in doubt,
RESET!
Don't force it.

Aim deep to the opponents' backcourt with height and spin.

HOW TO HIT A RESET SHOT

- 1 Get low and be ready early.



- 2 Open the paddle face slightly.



- 3 Brush up the back of the ball gently.



- 4 Send it high and deep over the net.



- 5 Recover and get back into position.



WHEN TO USE THE RESET SHOT



When under pressure.



When opponents are attacking.



When you are out of position.



To slow the game down and reset.



Buys you time and space.



Gets you back in the point.



Reduces unforced errors.



Leads to more opportunities to win points!

KEY BENEFITS

ATTACK THE KITCHEN

GET UP TO THE KITCHEN AND TAKE CONTROL!



The kitchen (NVZ) is where you want to be. The closer you are, the more pressure you put on your opponents.

GET UP EARLY,
STAY LOW,
BE READY!

**NVZ
(KITCHEN)**

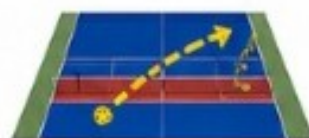
QUICK TIP



Move together as a team and close the distance to the kitchen as soon as you can safely do so.

HOW TO ATTACK THE KITCHEN

- 1 Win the serve or return with a good shot.



- 2 Move forward quickly and together.



- 3 Get to the kitchen line and stay low.



- 4 Be ready for the next shot. Keep the pressure on!



★ The kitchen is your best friend. Live there!

KEY STRATEGIES



Take space away from your opponents.



Move up early, not late.



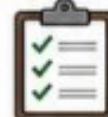
Stay low and be balanced.



Keep your shots low and deep.



Communicate and move together.



The team that controls the kitchen controls the game!

KEY TAKEAWAYS

★ GET UP. STAY LOW. ATTACK THE KITCHEN. WIN MORE POINTS! ★



ATTACK THE MIDDLE

GO WHERE IT'S OPEN. CONTROL THE MIDDLE!



Hitting to the middle keeps your opponents away from the sides and creates more openings.

THE MIDDLE IS OFTEN
YOUR BEST OPTION!

TARGET:
THE MIDDLE

QUICK TIP



Aim for the space between your opponents. Make them move!

HOW TO ATTACK THE MIDDLE

- 1 From the baseline or mid-court, choose the middle as your target.



- 2 Hit a controlled shot to the middle.



- 3 Make your opponents move and communicate.



- 4 Watch for the opening that your shot creates.



- 5 Be ready to move up and attack the next shot!



★ The middle is the key to offensive success!

WHY ATTACK THE MIDDLE?



Keeps opponents away from the sidelines.



Creates more openings.



Forces opponents to move and switch.



Increases your chance to win the rally.



Keep your eyes on the ball.



Stay balanced and ready.



Communicate with your partner.



Smart shots win more points!

IMPORTANT REMINDERS

★ SEE THE MIDDLE. HIT THE MIDDLE. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK THE WEAK SIDE

FIND IT. HIT IT. WIN IT!



The weak side is where your opponents are out of position or have less time to react. Attack it!

MAKE YOUR OPPONENTS MOVE. THEN ATTACK THE WEAK SIDE!

I'M OUT OF POSITION!

TARGET:
WEAK SIDE

QUICK TIP



Don't hit where they are.
Hit where they are going to be or can't get to!

HOW TO ATTACK THE WEAK SIDE

- 1 Observe your opponents and look for the weak side.



- 2 Hit a shot that makes them move or stretch.



- 3 When they are out of position, hit to the weak side.



- 4 Keep the pressure on and repeat!



★ Patience + Placement = Winning Points!

SIGNS OF A WEAK SIDE



Player out of position.



Player pulled out wide.



Player has less time to react.



Partner is covering too much court.



Player looks uncomfortable or stretched.



Creates openings.



Puts your opponents on the defensive.



Increases pressure.



Leads to more winning points!

★ FIND THE WEAK SIDE. MAKE THEM MOVE. FINISH THE POINT! ★

ATTACK THE STRAIGHT BALL

KEEP IT SIMPLE. GO STRAIGHT. SCORE MORE!



The straight ball is the most direct route to the point. Hit it with depth, accuracy and confidence!

GO STRAIGHT WHEN YOU CAN!

STRAIGHT AT HIM!

**TARGET:
BETWEEN YOUR
OPPONENTS OR AT
THE WEAKER ONE**

QUICK TIP



If there is a clear straight lane, don't hit around. Go through! Be aggressive!

HOW TO ATTACK THE STRAIGHT BALL

- 1 Look for the straight lane to the baseline or between players.



- 2 Set up early and turn your body sideways.



- 3 Swing forward with smooth, controlled power.



- 4 Follow through and stay balanced.



- 5 Recover and get ready for the next shot.



★ The straight ball keeps it simple and gets the job done!

KEY STRATEGIES



Take the shortest path to the target.



Aim deep to the baseline.



Read the court and see the straight lane.



Be confident and commit to your shot.



Keep it low over the net and on target.



Opponents are standing too wide.



Opponent is stuck or flat-footed.



Clear lane between players.



You have time and space.



Your team is in good position.

SIGNS YOU CAN ATTACK STRAIGHT

★ GO STRAIGHT. PLAY SMART. WIN MORE POINTS! ★

ATTACK THE DEEP BALL

DEPTH IS YOUR FRIEND. PUSH THEM BACK!



Hitting deep to the baseline gives you time, keeps you in control, and pushes your opponents back where they have less power and options.

HIT DEEP, MAKE THEM MOVE BACK, THEN LOOK FOR YOUR NEXT SHOT TO SCORE!

THAT'S DEEP!

HIT DEEP TO THE BASELINE

QUICK TIP



Aim high over the net and deep to the baseline. Let the ball do the work!

HOW TO ATTACK THE DEEP BALL

- 1 Take the ball early and move your feet into position.



- 2 Hit the ball high and deep to the baseline.



- 3 Push your opponents back and take time away from them.



- 4 Watch for a shorter return or a high ball.



- 5 Move in and attack the next ball!



★ Depth First.
Control Always.
Attack Smart.

WHY HIT DEEP?



Pushes opponents back to the baseline.



Gives you more time to get in position.



Reduces their power and aggression.



Creates better opportunities to score.



Keeps you in control of the rally.



Good footwork gets you there.



Keep your eyes on the ball.



Hit with height and confidence.



Stay patient and let the ball work!

KEYS TO SUCCESS

★ HIT DEEP. CONTROL THE RALLY. CREATE YOUR OPPORTUNITY. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK THE HIGH BALL

DON'T LET HIGH BALLS GIVE THEM THE ADVANTAGE!



**PALM BEACH
PICKLEBALL
ACADEMY**



High balls give your opponents time to move up, set up, and take control. Attack them early!

HIGH BALLS ARE OPPORTUNITIES. ATTACK THEM!

ATTACK ABOVE SHOULDER HEIGHT!

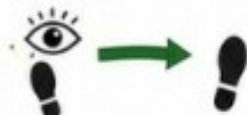
QUICK TIP



Step in, get under the ball, and attack down into the court. Be aggressive!

HOW TO ATTACK THE HIGH BALL

- 1 Track the ball early and move into position.



- 2 Get under the ball with good balance.



- 3 Take the ball out of the air and contact in front of your body.



- 4 Aim down into the court, deep or at their feet.



- 5 Recover forward and be ready for the next shot.



★ Attack with confidence. High ball. Easy target. Make them pay!

BENEFITS OF ATTACKING HIGH BALLS



Keeps opponents from moving up and attacking.



Puts you in control of the rally.



Takes time away from your opponents.



Creates pressure and forces their errors.



Helps you score more points!



High balls above shoulder height.



Short pop-ups and lobs into your court.



When you have time to get into position.



When you're balanced and confident.

WHEN TO ATTACK

★ SEE IT EARLY. MOVE IN. ATTACK DOWN. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK THE THIRD SHOT DROP

THE SETUP THAT OPENS THE COURT!



The third shot drop neutralizes the rally, brings you to the kitchen line, and sets you up to attack!

**DROP IT SOFT.
MOVE UP SMART.
ATTACK THE NEXT BALL!**

**DROP SOFT
INTO THE KITCHEN**

QUICK TIP



Aim deep, with soft pace and clean spin. Get it low and get it in!

Lower the ball over the net and let it bounce inside the kitchen.

HOW TO EXECUTE THE THIRD SHOT DROP

- 1** After the return of serve, take a step back and create space.



- 2** Use a soft grip and an open paddle face.



- 3** Swing low to high with control and brush up on the ball.



- 4** Aim for the kitchen, deep and near the baseline.



- 5** Move up to the kitchen line together and get ready to attack!



★ A great drop leads to an easy attack and more winning points!

WHY THE THIRD SHOT DROP WORKS



Takes time away from your opponents.



Neutralizes their attack.



Forces them to hit up and out of the kitchen.



Opens the court for an offensive opportunity.



Sets you up to attack and win points!



Hitting it too hard.



Hitting it too short.



Hitting it too high (over their heads).



Not moving up after the drop.

COMMON MISTAKES

★ DROP IT. MOVE UP. ATTACK. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK FROM THE KITCHEN LINE

SHORT GAME. BIG ADVANTAGE.



The kitchen line is your friend! Attacking from here keeps you close, gives you control, and puts pressure on your opponents.

STAY LOW.
STAY PATIENT.
ATTACK SMART!

ATTACK FROM THE KITCHEN LINE WITH CONTROL AND PURPOSE!

QUICK TIP



Use soft hands, quick reaction, and good placement. Quality over power wins!

HOW TO ATTACK FROM THE KITCHEN LINE

- 1 Move to the kitchen line after the third shot drop or when the ball is short.



- 2 Keep your paddle up and be ready.



- 3 Look for a short ball to attack.



- 4 Use a soft, controlled shot placed deep, to the corners or at their feet.



- 5 Stay in and be ready for the next shot.



★ Control the ball.
Control the point!

BEST SHOTS TO USE AT THE KITCHEN LINE



Soft Dink (Deep)



Roll Shot to the Corners



At Their Feet (Short)



Drop Shot (If They Back Up)



Push Shot (With Depth)



Be patient and wait for the right ball.



Watch the ball and your opponents.



Small edges create big wins!



Good placement beats power every time.

KEYS TO SUCCESS

★ GET TO THE KITCHEN LINE. ATTACK WITH CONTROL. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK THE MIDDLE!

CONTROL THE CENTER. WIN THE GAME.



The middle of the court is the most valuable area. Shots to the middle create confusion, limit angles, and open up the court for the winner!

**HIT TO THE
MIDDLE OF YOUR
OPPONENTS –
CONTROL THE POINT!**

**THE MIDDLE
IS YOUR
BEST FRIEND!**

QUICK TIP



When in doubt, hit to the middle. It's low risk and high reward!

HOW TO ATTACK THE MIDDLE

- 1 Move the ball around and create an opening.



- 2 Look for the middle space between your opponents.



- 3 Hit a controlled shot to the middle – not too hard!



- 4 Follow up and move forward to the NVZ (line) together.



- 5 Be ready for the next shot and keep controlling the point!

★ Control the middle.
★ Control the rally.
★ Control the win!

WHY ATTACK THE MIDDLE?



Creates confusion between your opponents.



Limits their angles and shot options.



Makes it harder for them to be aggressive.



Gives you control of the point.



Leads to more errors from your opponents.

BEST SHOTS TO THE MIDDLE



Third Shot Drop



Drive



Push



Dink



Reset

★ ATTACK SMART. HIT THE MIDDLE. WIN MORE POINTS! ★

ATTACK FROM THE BASELINE!

**MORE TIME. MORE OPTIONS.
BIGGER SHOTS. MORE PRESSURE.**



From the baseline, you have more time and a better view. Use that extra time to hit quality shots and move the ball with purpose!

**CREATE SPACE.
MOVE THE BALL.
ATTACK SMART!**

**PLAY SMART FROM
THE BASELINE AND
CONTROL THE COURT!**

QUICK TIP



Aim high, aim deep, or aim wide. Keep your opponents on the run!

HOW TO ATTACK FROM THE BASELINE

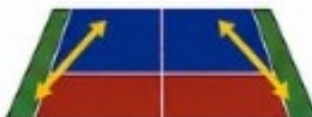
- 1 Get to the baseline after the return.



- 2 Create depth or angle with your shot.



- 3 Hit deep to the back, or wide to the sidelines.



- 4 Use topspin and control your pace.



- 5 Move forward after your shot and get ready for the next ball.



★ Big court.
Big shots.
Bigger advantage!

BEST SHOTS TO USE FROM THE BASELINE



Deep Drive
(To the Back)



Cross-Court
Drive



Angle Shot
(Wide)



Drop Shot
(Change Pace)



Lob Shot
(When Needed)



Stay back
after return.



Watch the ball
and the court.



Use depth
and angles.
shot.



Make your
opponent
move!

KEYS TO SUCCESS

★ MORE TIME. BETTER OPTIONS. ATTACK WITH CONFIDENCE. WIN THE POINT! ★

ATTACK FROM THE HALF-VOLLEY!

**STRIKE EARLY. STAY AGGRESSIVE.
TAKE TIME AWAY.**



A half-volley is hit before the ball bounces. It's fast, low, and puts your opponents on defense right away! Be quick and confident!

**BE EARLY.
BE AGGRESSIVE.
ATTACK BEFORE
THE BOUNCE!**

**HIT IT EARLY.
HIT IT LOW.
HIT IT HARD.
MAKE THEM REACT!**

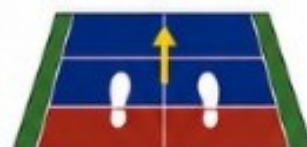
QUICK TIP



Move up after your partner's shot and be ready to take the ball out of the air!

HOW TO ATTACK FROM THE HALF-VOLLEY

- 1 Move up after the return and get into a ready position.



- 2 Watch the ball closely as it comes over the net.



- 3 Hit the ball out of the air (before it bounces).



- 4 Aim deep, to the corners, or at their feet.



- 5 Stay ready and move forward for the next shot.



★ **Be early.
Be aggressive.
Win the point!**

BEST SHOTS TO USE FROM THE HALF-VOLLEY



Punch Shot
(Fast & Low)



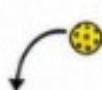
Angle Shot
(To the Corners)



Down the Line
(At Their Feet)



Drive
(Deep & Hard)



Lob
(When Needed)



Be quick
and early.



Take time away
from opponents.



Attack with
confidence!



Keep pressure
on all the time!

★ **STRIKE EARLY. TAKE CONTROL. ATTACK FROM THE HALF-VOLLEY AND WIN!** ★

SESSION 46

ATTACK FROM THE DRIVE!



**DEEP, FAST, AND WITH PURPOSE.
DRIVE TO TAKE CONTROL.**



The drive is one of the most effective shots in pickleball. It keeps the ball low, adds speed, and pushes your opponents back—giving you time and control to win the point!

**DRIVE DEEP.
DRIVE LOW.
ATTACK SMART!**

**DRIVE WITH CONFIDENCE.
PUT PRESSURE ON
YOUR OPPONENTS
AND TAKE CONTROL
OF THE POINT!**

QUICK TIP



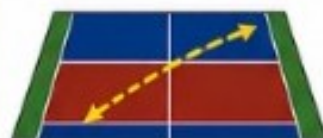
A great drive starts with balance, good footwork, and looking at the ball all the way!

HOW TO ATTACK FROM THE DRIVE

- 1 Get in an athletic stance and prepare early.



- 2 Hit a deep drive cross-court or down the line.



- 3 Keep the ball low and over the net.



- 4 Move forward and take the court.



- 5 Stay aggressive and look for the next opportunity to finish the point!

**★ Drive with purpose.
Win with pressure.
Finish with control!**

BEST DRIVES TO USE



Cross-Court Drive



Down the Line Drive



Body Drive
(At the Opponent)



Approach Drive
(To Come In)



Drive with Spins
(Topspin)



Stay balanced and be ready early.



Watch the ball and track it all the way.



Hit with pace but keep it controlled.



Take the court and control the point.



Pressure your opponents to make errors.

KEYS TO SUCCESS

★ **DRIVE DEEP. STAY LOW. ATTACK WITH CONFIDENCE. WIN THE POINT!** ★

ATTACK WITH THE LOB!

CHANGE THE PACE. LIFT IT OVER.
TAKE CONTROL.



The lob is a high shot that lands deep in your opponent's court. It buys you time, creates distance, and opens the court for you to move up and attack the next shot!

**LOB SMART.
RESET POSITION.
THEN ATTACK!**

**A GOOD LOB
TODAY CAN
WIN THE
POINT
TOMORROW!**

QUICK TIP



Use the lob when opponents are at the net, stuck back, or you need time to recover and reset.

WHEN TO USE THE LOB



Opponents are at the net.



You need time to recover or change positions.



Opponents are crowding the kitchen.



You want to change the tempo.



You want more time to set up the next shot.

TYPES OF LOBS



Deep Lob



Cross-Court Lob



Straight Lob



Defensive Lob (High & Safe)



Situational Lob (Off the Back)

HOW TO ATTACK WITH THE LOB

- 1 Find the right moment to lob—when opponents are at the net or crowding the kitchen.



- 2 Use a smooth, high backswing and contact the ball out in front.



- 3 Aim deep—near the baseline (end line).



- 4 After the lob, move back and reset to the middle with your partner.



- 5 Be ready to move up and attack the next short or weak shot.



**LOB IT. RESET IT.
ATTACK IT!**

ATTACK WITH THE SPEED-UP!

**TURN DEFENSE INTO OFFENSE.
SPEED IT UP AND FINISH THE POINT!**



The speed-up is a medium-to-hard shot hit with pace after a dink or soft ball. It catches your opponents off guard and creates the opportunity to win the point!

**STAY PATIENT.
SEE THE OPPORTUNITY.
SPEED IT UP
AND ATTACK!**

**READ IT.
RECOGNIZE IT.
SPEED IT UP
AND TAKE CONTROL!**

QUICK TIP



Don't speed up every dink—wait for the right ball! Look for one that sits up or is short and in hitting range.

HOW TO ATTACK WITH THE SPEED-UP

- 1 Watch for a dink that sits up, is short, or pops slightly higher.



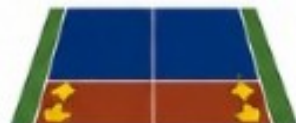
- 2 Step in and prepare early with a compact backswing.



- 3 Accelerate through the ball and hit a controlled, paced shot.



- 4 Aim at the open space—cross-court, down the line, or at their feet.



- 5 Move forward after your shot and be ready to finish the point.



★ The speed-up creates pressure—pressure wins points!

BEST SPEED-UP TARGETS



Cross-court (open sideline)



Down the line (opponent out of position)



At their feet (low and fast)



To their weaker player



Open space (avoid the strong side)



Watch the ball and wait for your opportunity



Use good footwork and be balanced



Short backswing, fast forward swing



Stay patient—select the right ball



Attack with confidence and commit fully

KEYS TO SUCCESS

★ GOOD DINKS SET UP. SPEED-UPS WIN POINTS! SEE IT. GO FOR IT. WIN IT! ★

ATTACK THE KITCHEN LINE!

**CONTROL THE KITCHEN. CONTROL THE POINT.
MOVE IN AND ATTACK WITH PURPOSE!**



The kitchen line is where points are won or lost. Moving in after a weak return or a well-placed shot puts pressure on your opponents and gives you the best chance to win the point!

**MOVE IN.
OWN THE KITCHEN.
FINISH THE POINT!**

**GET TO THE KITCHEN FIRST
AND MAKE YOUR OPPONENTS
PLAY DEFENSE!**

QUICK TIP



Move in together with your partner. Stay low, stay ready, and keep the pressure on!

HOW TO ATTACK THE KITCHEN LINE

- 1 Look for a short, weak, or high return.



- 2 Hit a shot with depth, angle, or pace.



- 3 Move in after your shot and take control of the kitchen line.



- 4 Keep the ball low and attack every opportunity.



- 5 Finish the point with confidence!



★ **Control the kitchen.
Dominate the point.
Win more!**

BEST SHOTS TO GET TO THE KITCHEN



Third Shot Drop
(Soft & Low)



Drive with
Depth



Angle Shot
(Across Court)



Lob to the
Back



Push or Reset
(Deep & Low)



Move in
Together



Watch the Ball
and Opponent



Stay Low
and Ready



Attack Every
Opportunity



Finish With
Purpose

★ **GET IN. STAY IN. ATTACK AND WIN! CONTROL THE KITCHEN, CONTROL THE GAME!** ★

PICKLEBALL EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST

THE RIGHT GEAR = MORE FUN, BETTER PERFORMANCE, FEWER INJURIES!



**PALM BEACH
PICKLEBALL
ACADEMY**

1 PADDLE



- ✓ Choose a paddle that feels comfortable and easy to control.
- ✓ Composite or graphite faces are great for beginners.

2 PICKLEBALL



- ✓ Outdoor balls for outdoor courts.
- ✓ Indoor balls for indoor courts.

3 COURT SHOES



- ✓ Use court shoes with good lateral support.
- ✓ Running shoes can increase your risk of injury.

4 EYE PROTECTION



- ✓ Protect your eyes from fast balls, sun, and glare.

5 COMFORTABLE APPAREL



- ✓ Lightweight, breathable, and allows you to move freely.

6 HAT / VISOR



- ✓ Keeps the sun out of your eyes and helps you stay cool.

7 WATER BOTTLE



Stay hydrated before, during, and after you play.

8 TOWEL



Use it to wipe sweat and keep your grip comfortable.

9 GRIP TAPE



Keeps your paddle grip secure and comfortable.

10 BACKPACK OR BAG



Keeps all your equipment organized and easy to carry.

11 SUNSCREEN



Protect your skin and play safely in the sun.

TIPS FOR BEGINNERS



Start simple. You don't need expensive gear to have fun!



Try before you buy. Test different paddles and find what feels best for you.



Take care of your gear and it will take care of your game!



Most important—bring a good attitude and enjoy every moment!



WHAT YOU REALLY NEED TO GET STARTED



PADDLE

+



BALL

+



COURT SHOES

+



WATER

+



POSITIVE ATTITUDE

=



**YOU'RE
READY
TO PLAY!**

★ GOOD GEAR. SMART CHOICES. MORE FUN ON THE COURT! ★

PICKLEBALL COURT DIAGRAM

KNOW YOUR COURT. PLAY WITH CONFIDENCE!

COURT SIZE



20 FEET WIDE
44 FEET LONG

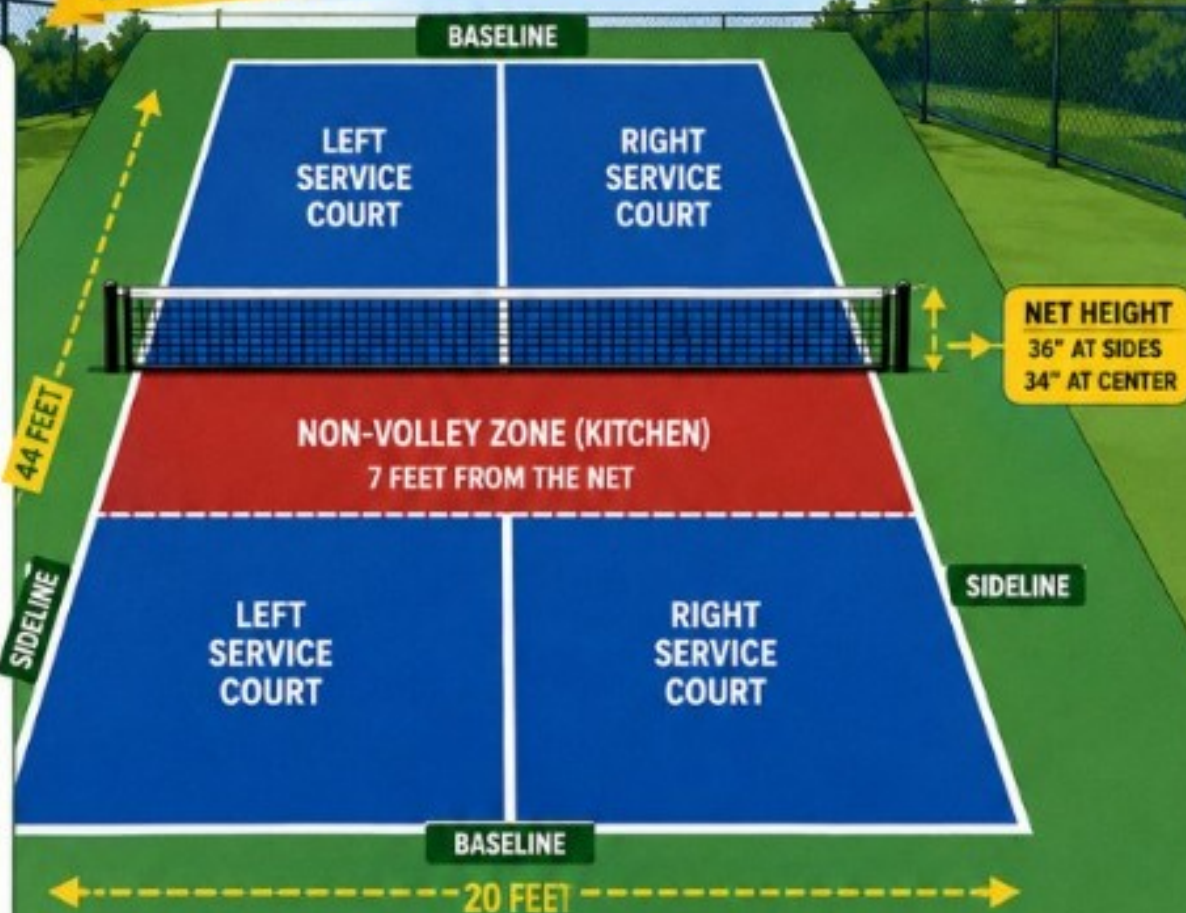
WHAT'S WHAT?

SERVICE COURTS
Hit the ball here to start the rally.

NON-VOLLEY ZONE (KITCHEN)
You cannot hit volleys in this area.

OUT OF BOUNDS
The ball must land inside the lines to be in play.

NET
Divides the court. Volley across with control!



KEY AREAS EXPLAINED

SERVICE COURTS



Used to serve the ball diagonally to start every rally.

NON-VOLLEY ZONE (KITCHEN)



No volleys allowed here. Let the ball bounce before you hit.

BASELINE



Stand behind the baseline when serving or returning serve.

SIDELINES



The ball must land inside the lines to be in play.

CENTER LINE



Divides the left and right service courts on each side.

COURT OVERVIEW



- 1 Serve Diagonally
- 2 Let it Bounce
- 3 Rally Begins!

QUICK REMINDERS

- ✓ Serve underhand diagonally.
- ✗ No volleys in the kitchen.
- 👥 Always let the ball bounce in the kitchen.
- 😊 Play fair, have fun, and enjoy the game!



PICKLEBALL COURT ZONES

EACH ZONE HAS A PURPOSE. KNOW THEM. USE THEM. WIN MORE POINTS!

WHAT'S WHAT?

SERVICE COURTS

Hit the ball here to start the rally.



NON-VOLLEY ZONE (KITCHEN)

You cannot hit volleys in this area.

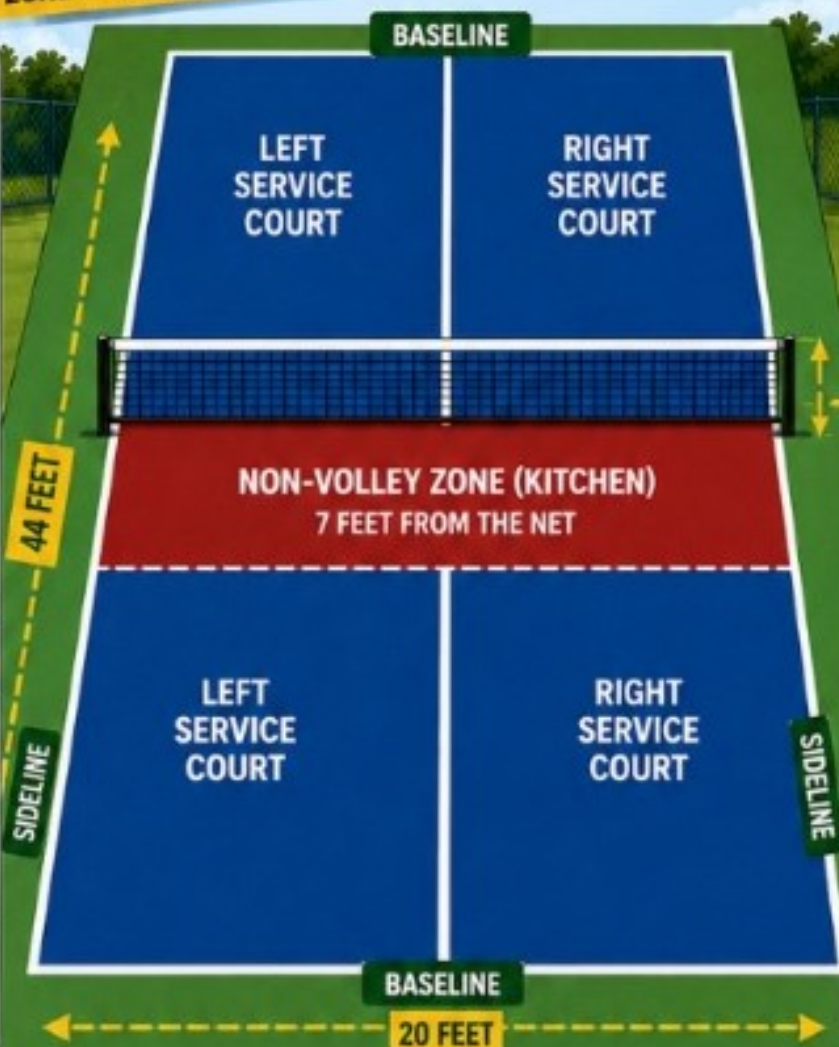


OUT OF BOUNDS

The ball must land inside the lines to be in play.

NET

Divides the court. Volley across with control!



ZONE TIPS

SERVICE COURTS

Use deep, accurate serves to start strong. Aim for the corners.



KITCHEN

Great for dinks and resets. No volleys here!



BASELINE

Hit deep shots from here. It gives you more time.



SIDELINES

Work together and cover your side of the court.



CENTER LINE

Keeps the left and right service courts separated.



THE KITCHEN RULE

NO VOLLEYS IN THE KITCHEN!

YOU CAN'T

Volleys are not allowed inside the kitchen. You will fault.



YOU CAN

Let the ball bounce in the kitchen, then you can hit it.



IDEAL POSITION

Stay just behind the kitchen line. Be ready to move in any direction!



Balanced and Ready at the Kitchen Line!

QUICK ZONE GUIDE



Serve from the service courts.



No volleys in the kitchen.



Dink in the kitchen.



Move back to the baseline for power.



Communicate and cover your zone.

REMEMBER

- ✓ Control the kitchen.
- ✓ Hit deep from the baseline.
- ✓ Cover your zone.
- ✓ Work together.
- ✓ Have fun!



PICKLEBALL PLAYER LEVELS

WHERE ARE YOU? KNOW YOUR LEVEL. SET YOUR GOALS. KEEP IMPROVING!

ALL PLAYERS START HERE!

Focus on skills,
play often, be
positive and
have fun!



SKILL • CONSISTENCY • STRATEGY • CONFIDENCE



5.0

ADVANCED

Competes at a high level.
Has a complete game.
Consistent. Strategic. Strong.



4.0

UPPER INTERMEDIATE

Controls the game.
Uses spins and strategy.
Makes few unforced errors.



3.0

INTERMEDIATE

Good shot variety and control.
Understands strategy.
Rallies with consistency.



2.5

ADVANCING BEGINNER

Developing consistency.
Improving shot placement.
Learning basic strategy.



2.0

BEGINNER

Learning the basic strokes.
Improving consistency.
Learning the rules and positioning.



1.0

NEW TO PICKLEBALL

Just starting out.
Learning the rules.
Focus on having fun!



WHAT IMPROVES YOUR LEVEL?



PRACTICE

Play often and
with purpose.



LEARN

Understand
strategy and
the game.



STAY FIT

Better fitness
helps your
game.



PLAY SMART

Make good
decisions on
the court.



HAVE FUN

Positive attitude
makes every
game better!

HOW TO MOVE UP TO THE NEXT LEVEL

- ✓ Master the basics
- ✓ Be consistent
- ✓ Play with better players
- ✓ Take lessons or clinics
- ✓ Watch, learn, and adapt
- ✓ Stay patient and enjoy the journey!

PATH TO IMPROVEMENT



LEARN
the basics



PRACTICE
regularly



PLAY
with others



MEASURE
your progress



ACHIEVE
your goals

REMEMBER

- ✓ Everyone improves at their own pace.
- ✓ Enjoy the journey as much as the results.
- ✓ Great players were once beginners too!



YOUR LEVEL TODAY DOES NOT LIMIT YOUR POTENTIAL TOMORROW.
KEEP PLAYING. KEEP LEARNING. KEEP IMPROVING. HAVE FUN!

PICKLEBALL

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKES

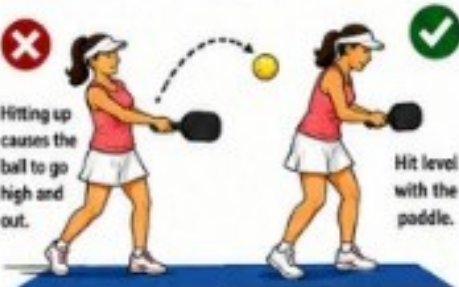
AVOID THESE. IMPROVE FASTER. HAVE MORE FUN!

1 NOT READY POSITION



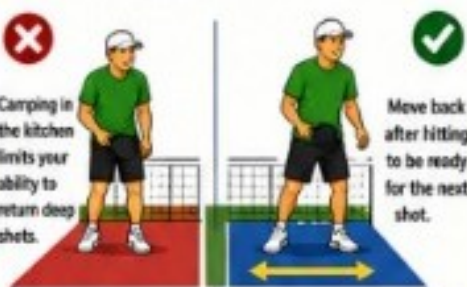
TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Always be in an athletic ready position.

2 HITTING UP ON THE BALL



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Keep your paddle level from start to finish.

3 STAYING IN THE KITCHEN



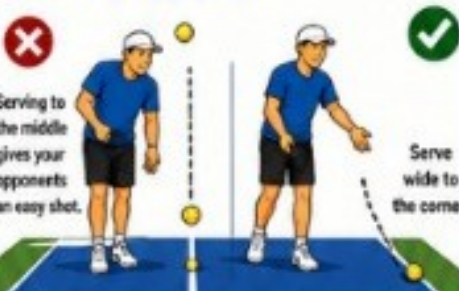
TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Hit and move back. Don't live in the kitchen!

4 POPPING UP DINKS



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Dink low and soft. Patience wins points!

5 POOR SERVE PLACEMENT



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Aim for the corner. Make them move!

6 NOT WATCHING THE BALL



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Eyes on the ball from the bounce to contact.

7 RUSHING THE SHOT



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Be calm. Let the ball come to you.

8 NOT COMMUNICATING WITH YOUR PARTNER



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Communicate early and often.

9 OVERHITTING EVERY SHOT



TRY THIS INSTEAD:
Use soft hands and good placement.

QUICK REMINDERS



BE READY
Stay low and be prepared for every shot.



KEEP YOUR EYES
On the ball from start to finish.



PLAY SMART
Use angles, placement, and strategy.



WORK TOGETHER
Communicate and support your partner.



HAVE FUN
Positive attitude makes every game better!

REMEMBER

- ✓ Mistakes are normal.
- ✓ Learn, adjust, and improve.
- ✓ Every great player was once a beginner!



AVOID MISTAKES. BUILD GOOD HABITS. BECOME A BETTER PLAYER!

PICKLEBALL PRACTICE DRILLS

PRACTICE WITH PURPOSE. IMPROVE EVERY DAY. HAVE FUN!

WHY DRILLS?

- ✓ Build consistency
- ✓ Improve skills
- ✓ Increase confidence
- ✓ Make games more fun!



TIPS FOR SUCCESS



FOCUS
Quality over quantity.



BE CONSISTENT
Practice regularly.



START SIMPLE
Master the basics first.



HAVE A PARTNER
Makes drills more effective and fun.



STAY POSITIVE
Enjoy the process and keep going!

1 DINKING CONSISTENCY DRILL

Hit dinks back and forth cross-court.



★ KEY FOCUS: Soft hands, control, and placement.

2 TARGET DINK DRILL

Aim your dinks to the target zone each time.



★ KEY FOCUS: Accuracy and consistency.

3 THIRD SHOT DROP DRILL

Practice your third shot drop over and over.



★ KEY FOCUS: Soft drop, depth, and control.

4 CROSS-COURT RALLY DRILL

Keep the ball going cross-court.



★ KEY FOCUS: Consistency and patience.

5 DRIVE & RESET DRILL

Drive deep, then reset with a soft shot.



★ KEY FOCUS: Power, then control.

6 AT THE KITCHEN DRILL

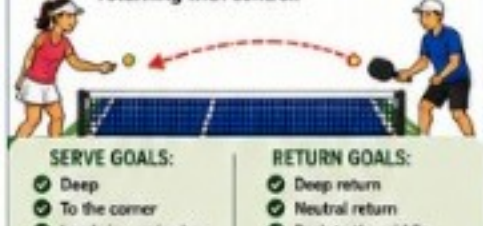
Hit from the kitchen line only. No volleys!



★ KEY FOCUS: Dinks, drops, and positioning.

7 SERVE & RETURN DRILL

Practice serving and returning with control.



SERVE GOALS:

- ✓ Deep
- ✓ To the corner
- ✓ Lands in service box

RETURN GOALS:

- ✓ Deep return
- ✓ Neutral return
- ✓ Back to the middle

★ KEY FOCUS: Consistent serve and return.

8 MOVE & RESET DRILL

Move side to side, hit, then reset to center.



★ KEY FOCUS: Footwork and recovery.

9 LOB & OVERHEAD DRILL

Practice lobbs and overhead smashes.



LOB GOALS:

- ✓ High
- ✓ Deep
- ✓ Land near baseline

OVERHEAD GOALS:

- ✓ Step in
- ✓ Contact high
- ✓ Hit down

★ KEY FOCUS: Height, depth, and timing.

DRILL PROGRESSION

Make it harder as you improve!

BEGINNER

Shorter rallies
Slower pace
Basic targets



INTERMEDIATE

Longer rallies
More movement
Smaller targets



ADVANCED

Game speed
Random targets
Add pressure



EQUIPMENT YOU CAN USE



CONES



TARGETS



LADDER



BALL BUCKET



TAPE

MAKE IT FUN!

Invite a friend, challenge each other, and celebrate improvement!



REMEMBER

- ✓ Warm up first.
- ✓ Stay hydrated.
- ✓ Take breaks.
- ✓ Track your progress.
- ✓ Enjoy the game!



★ PRACTICE TODAY. PLAY BETTER TOMORROW. HAVE FUN ALWAYS! ★

PICKLEBALL SCORE CALLING

CALL IT CLEAR. CALL IT CONFIDENT. KEEP THE GAME MOVING!

THE BASICS



Only the **SERVING TEAM** can score.



Call the score **BEFORE** each serve.



Be loud, clear and confident!



HOW TO CALL THE SCORE

TEAM A
SCORE

TEAM B
SCORE

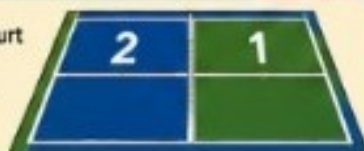
SERVER
NUMBER

SERVICE
COURT

7 - 5 - 2 - 1
"7 - 5 - 2 - 1"
SCORE SCORE SERVER COURT



- ✓ Call the score in order: Score - Score - Server - Court
- ✓ Server 1 always serves from the RIGHT court (1).
- ✓ Servers switch courts after each point scored.



EXAMPLE: TEAM A IS SERVING

START OF GAME

Score: 0 - 0 - 1 - 1
Server 1 on Right Court (1)



Only the serving team can score.

TEAM A SCORES!

Score: 1 - 0 - 1 - 2
Server 1 moves to Left Court (2)



Server 1 scored. Now he serves from the Left Court (2).

TEAM A SCORES AGAIN!

Score: 2 - 0 - 1 - 1
Server 1 back to Right Court (1)



Server 1 scored again. Back to Right Court (1).

SERVICE PASSES

Team B Wins Rally
Score: 2 - 0 - 1 - 1
Now Team B Serves.



Team B now serves. They will call the score.

SERVER NUMBER

- At the start of the game and when service changes, the first server is 1.



- If a fault occurs while serving, the same server tries again.

The server number does not change.



QUICK REFERENCE



Only the serving team can score.



Call the score before each serve.



Servers switch courts after each point.



Be loud, clear and confident!



COMMON MISTAKES

✗

5 - 2 - 1 - 2?

Wrong order. Always call: Score - Score - Server - Court.



✗

3 - 1

Not calling all four numbers. Call all four!



✗

Wrong Court!

Serving from wrong court. Check the number!



✗

Too soft!

Not loud enough. Speak up! Let everyone hear you!



REMEMBER

- ✓ Call it loud.
- ✓ Call it clear.
- ✓ Call it in order.
- ✓ Have fun!



GOOD COMMUNICATION = BETTER GAMES!
CALL IT RIGHT. PLAY IT RIGHT. ENJOY PICKLEBALL!